

L'cha Dodi

(for Ben HaMetzarim)

10w

Version 2

Israel Meyer Japhet
Arr. Stuart Izon

There is a generally well-known practice of changing the tune for L'cha Dodi on the Shabbat preceding Tisha b'Av to the melody for Eli Tzion. However, the real historical practice is a little more complicated:

Many of the classic synagogue composers wrote L'cha Dodi melodies for the three weeks, not exclusively on the Eli Tzion theme, but incorporating it somewhere either as a refrain or for just one of the verses. However, each of these compositions is individual, there is no one universal melody across Nusach Ashkenaz. These melodies were also typically composed for the whole three week period, not just for Shabbat Chazon.

Japhet's score is an exception – in addition to his L'cha Dodi for Shabbat Chazon, he wrote this separate melody (which does not include Eli Tzion) for the other two Shabbatot. This arrangement contains only the first part of his melody, which is reprised for the final verse, Boi V'shalom.

Some commentators disagreed with the practice of using a sad tune for L'cha Dodi, since public mourning is generally forbidden on Shabbat. Some congregations get around this by ensuring that Kabbalat Shabbat is said before sunset (easier in the Northern hemisphere at this time of year). Others will use the Eli Tzion melody for only one, or a few of the verses. Perhaps this is partly the reason why some communities only change the tune for Shabbat Chazon.

Andantino

Melody Alto

Tenor Bass

6

M A

T B

L' - cha do - di li - krat ka - la p' -

-nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la

10

M
A

8

L' - cha do - di lik - rat ka - la p' -

T
B

15

M
A

8

- nei sha - bat n' - ka - - b' - la

T
B

19

M
A

8

Sha - mor v' - za - chor b' - di - bur e - chad
Bo - i v' - sha - lom a - te - ret ba - la

T
B

24

M
A

8

hish - mi - a - nu el ha - m' - yu - chad a - do -
gam b' - sim - cha uv - tza - ho - la

T
B

28

M
A

8

-nai e - chad ush - mo e - chad l' -
toch e - mu - nei am s' - gu - la

T
B

32

M
A

8

-shem ul - ti - fe - ret v' - lit - hi - la
bo - i cha - la bo - i cha - la

T
B

36

M
A

8

L' - cha do - di lik - rat ka - la p' -

T
B

41

M
A

8

-nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la

T
B